READ FIRST

# When plans change

Read the extract. Discuss the questions with a partner and use details from the text.

**The situation:** Fiona has just received her Assignment. Jonas expects his turn next. He belongs to the Elevens and is about to become a Twelve. **Nineteen is his birth and ceremony number, not his age.**

**LOIS LOWRY, THE GIVER | CHAPTER 7, PRINTED PAGE 57**

Jonas prepared himself to walk to the stage when the applause ended and the Chief Elder picked up the next folder and looked down to the group to call forward the next new Twelve. He was calm now that his turn had come. He took a deep breath and smoothed his hair with his hand.

"Twenty," he heard her voice say clearly. "Pierre." She skipped me, Jonas thought, stunned. Had he heard wrong? No. There was a sudden hush in the crowd, and he knew that the entire community realized that the Chief Elder had moved from Eighteen to Twenty, leaving a gap. On his right, Pierre, with a startled look, rose from his seat and moved to the stage.

A mistake. She made a mistake. But Jonas knew, even as he had the thought, that she hadn't. The Chief Elder made no mistakes. Not at the Ceremony of Twelve.

He felt dizzy, and couldn't focus his attention. He didn't hear what Assignment Pierre received, and was only dimly aware of the applause as the boy returned, wearing his new badge. Then: Twenty-one. Twenty-two.

The numbers continued in order. Jonas sat, dazed, as they moved into the Thirties and then the Forties, nearing the end. Each time, at each announcement, his heart jumped for a moment, and he thought wild thoughts. Perhaps now she would call his name. Could he have forgotten his own number? No. He had always been Nineteen. He was sitting in the seat marked Nineteen.

But she had skipped him.

## 1 Understand the moment

**1.** What is Jonas preparing to do? Which actions show that he expects his turn?

**2.** What happens instead, and how does it interrupt his intended action?

**3.** How do his feelings change? Does he stop hoping that his name will be called?

THINK BEFORE THE RULE

# Discover the pattern

Talk through each step and explain your choices to a partner.

## 2 Freeze the story

> “Perhaps now she would call his name.”

**1.** At the moment of this thought, has the Chief Elder called Jonas’s name?

**2.** Is being called before this thought, or still in Jonas’s future?

**3.** The story is told in the past. Which two words look forward from that past moment?

## 3 Compare an expectation and an intention

**A.** Jonas thought she **would call** his number next.

**B.** He **was going to walk** onto the stage, but she called Pierre.

These two sentences are classroom paraphrases based on the scene, not quotations from the novel.

**1.** Which sentence describes what Jonas believed would happen? Which describes what he intended to do?

**2.** In sentence B, which words tell us that his intended next action was interrupted?

**3.** What form of the verb follows **would**? What form follows **was going to**? Compare call with called, and walk with walking.

## 4 Say the rule before you check

Explain these patterns to your partner. Choose the words that fit.

**Time:** From a past point of view, these expressions look **forward / backward**.

**Expectation:** would + **base verb / past form / -ing form**

**Intention:** was / were going to + **base verb / past form / -ing form**

Then turn the page to check your discovery and revisit the scene through the cartoons.

CHECK, THEN EXPLAIN

# Return to Jonas

Compare your discovery with the rule. Then use it to explain the cartoon sequence.

**Future in the Past:** we look forward from an earlier moment.
**would + base verb** can report an earlier expectation.
**was / were going to + base verb** can describe an earlier intention.

The form alone does not tell us whether the later action happened. Here, the rest of the story shows that Jonas's intended next action was interrupted.

Look at panels 1–3. Explain what Jonas expected, what interrupted his intention, and what he still hoped would happen.




### Panel 4: an imagined conversation

**Fiona:** What did you think would happen?
**Jonas:** I thought she would call my number. I was going to walk onto the stage, but she called Pierre.

The illustrations and conversation are classroom adaptations. This exchange does not appear in the novel.